

# Joshua Hickman

Linux systems administration · Networking · IT operations

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|-------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
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| Credentials | <a href="#">Credly</a>                                                                    |

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**Important.** Open to technician and administrator roles with MSPs and internal IT teams. Contact by email only.

## Summary

**Note.** U.S. Army veteran changing careers into Linux, networking, and IT operations after two decades of designing, documenting, and keeping multi-component systems running.

I operate a multi-node Linux lab and am preparing for the LFCS exam (target September 2026). The habit is the same as the last twenty years: understand the system, write down what you did, stay with the problem until it is closed.

## Skills

| Area       | What I use                                                            |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Linux      | Ubuntu, Rocky Linux, systemd, LVM, permissions, packages, rebuilds    |
| Networking | VLANs, routing, Tailscale, WireGuard, ACLs, SSH, Starlink, mesh Wi-Fi |
| Edge / lab | VyOS, OPNsense (study), segmented home/lab LANs                       |
| Operations | Homelab fleet, Nextcloud, Docker, Borg, runbooks, change notes        |
| Scripting  | Bash, Python fundamentals, Git, SQL / PostgreSQL fundamentals         |
| Quality    | SOPs, inventories, Lean Six Sigma Yellow Belt (DMAIC)                 |

| Area             | What I use                                                                             |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Delivery         | Training non-technical operators, ticket ownership, clean handoff                      |
| AI-assisted work | Grok, Claude Code, Ollama, Gemini CLI, Copilot — draft only; I test and own the result |

### Lab in practice

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Independent lab, 2025 – present · [homelab spec sheets](#) · [installers](#)

| Layer    | What is running / documented                                                 |
|----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Edge     | Starlink WAN, VyOS, lab LAN vs home LAN, no inbound WAN ports                |
| Compute  | Control seat plus a three-node Ubuntu fleet                                  |
| Access   | Dual Tailscale identities (lab vs home), SSH                                 |
| Services | File / collaboration / backup practice (Nextcloud installer in public repos) |
| Proof    | Public notes, not unused coursework                                          |

**Tip.** Daily work: design, implement, document, recover. Segmentation, VPN, 2FA, quotas, and rebuild runbooks.

### Experience

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| When                | Role                                                 | Where                                         |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Jul 2025 – present  | Career transition — Linux, networking, IT operations | Independent · Omak, WA                        |
| Mar 2024 – Jul 2025 | County Compliance Planner                            | Okanogan County Planning & Development        |
| Dec 2022 – Jan 2025 | Organizational leader                                | New Life Center, Okanogan, WA                 |
| 2013 – 2016         | Training systems and S6 support                      | U.S. Army, 1st Medical Brigade, Fort Hood, TX |
| 2005 – 2025         | Audio systems engineer and consultant                | Self-employed                                 |

#### Career transition — Linux, networking, IT operations

Independent professional development · Omak, WA · July 2025 – present

- Linux Foundation LFS101 and LFS207 (April 2026); badges on Credly. LFCS exam purchased; target September 2026.
- Google AI Essentials (September 2025) and Nucamp Python and Web fundamentals.
- Live Linux and network services; AI tools as a bench aid, not a substitute for testing.

**Tip.** Maps to technician / junior-admin work: services, access, documentation, repeatable operations — while credentials finish on a dated path.

## County Compliance Planner

Okanogan County Office of Planning & Development · March 2024 – July 2025

- Permits and applications against county and state requirements.
- Official records and departmental standard operating procedures.

**Note.** Same muscle as change control, ticket notes, and audit-ready ops.

## Organizational leader

New Life Center, Okanogan, WA · December 2022 – January 2025

- Day-to-day operations: scheduling, facilities, communications, volunteers.
- DMAIC rebuild of policies, budgets, reporting, and leadership training.
- Membership 18 → 55; annual loss → surplus.
- Trained people on Google Workspace, Planning Center, and Breeze.

**Note.** Multi-hat shop: implement the system, train the next person, keep it running with thin headcount.

## Training systems and S6 support

U.S. Army, 1st Medical Brigade, Fort Hood, TX · 2013 – 2016

- Training information systems (DTMS / ATRRS) for 3,500+ soldiers; audit-ready records.
- S6 support: PC deployment, VOIP, AV, SharePoint; Army IT training (VMs, hardware, collaboration).
- SOPs for severe-weather and CBRNE response; exercises with 4,000+ personnel.
- Awards: Army Commendation Medal, Army Good Conduct Medal, two Special Achievement Medals.

**Tip.** Closest prior match to enterprise IT: information systems, endpoints, comms, SOPs, pressure.

## Audio systems engineer and consultant

Self-employed · 2005 – 2025

- Designed, installed, and optimized multi-component sound systems; live signal-chain diagnosis.
- Ran a mobile studio end-to-end and trained operators so the system ran after handoff.

**Note.** Infrastructure as signal flow: design it, stand it up, teach the next operator.

## How prior work maps to the job

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| Prior work                 | Habit that transfers                               |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Army S6 / training systems | Enterprise records, endpoints, comms, SOPs         |
| County planning            | Audit-ready documentation, process control         |
| Nonprofit operations       | Thin-staff delivery, end-user training             |
| Live audio                 | Troubleshooting under time pressure, clean handoff |
| Current lab                | Linux, routing, remote access, written runbooks    |

## Education and certifications

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| Credential                                                                            | Status                                                                     |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>LFCS</b> (Linux Foundation Certified System Administrator)                         | Exam purchased · target <b>September 2026</b> (voucher through March 2027) |
| CompTIA Linux+ and Network+                                                           | Planned within 12 months of LFCS                                           |
| LFS101 — Introduction to Linux                                                        | Completed 3 April 2026 · <a href="#">Credly</a>                            |
| LFS207 — Linux System Administration Essentials                                       | Completed 15 April 2026 · <a href="#">Credly</a>                           |
| Google AI Essentials (5 courses)                                                      | Completed 12 September 2025                                                |
| Nucamp — Python Fundamentals; Web Development Fundamentals                            | Completed                                                                  |
| Lean Six Sigma Yellow Belt (Alison)                                                   | Completed                                                                  |
| Master of Theology, Crown Institute of Theology (WA state-licensed)                   | 2020 – 2026                                                                |
| U.S. Army Medical Training Center — Patient Administration; Army IT / VM / SharePoint | 2013                                                                       |
| References available upon request. Email only.                                        |                                                                            |